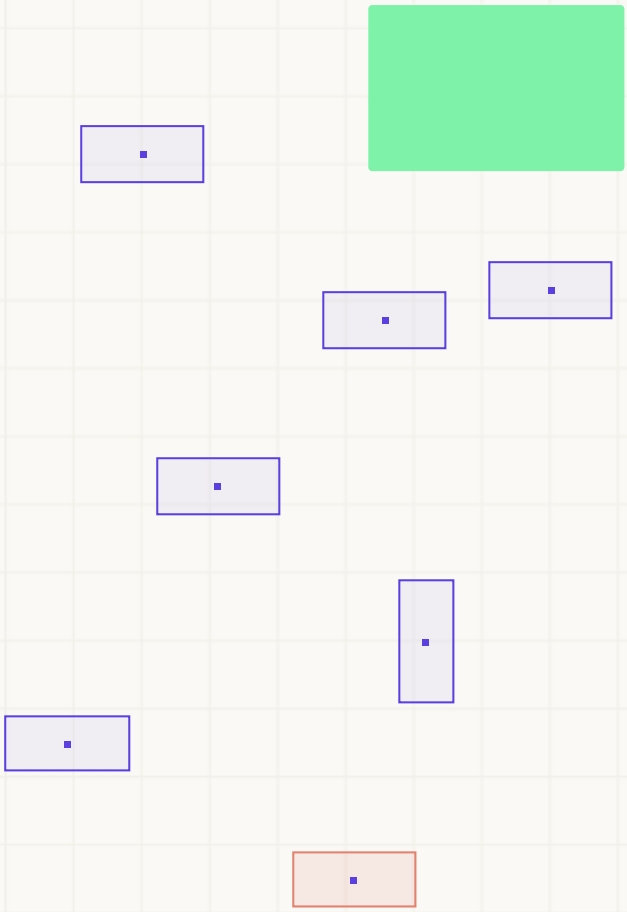
LAAI | AI FOR CONSTRUCTION



# Before you implement AI: the risks to know

A practical overview for architecture offices, builders, contractors and developers: what can go wrong with AI, how to spot it early, and how to reduce it.

**INSIDE**
8 risks with real examples, a risk map, the rules to know, a checklist and a policy template

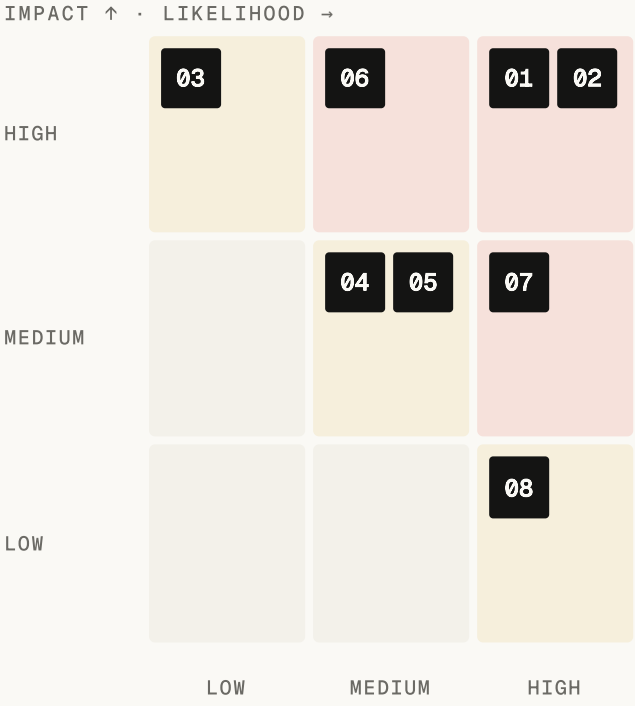
**WRITTEN BY**
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WHY READ THIS

# AI saves time. Used carelessly, it also creates new risks.

Most problems with AI in construction are not technical. They come from data shared in the wrong place, answers nobody checked, and tools nobody owns. All of them can be reduced with a few simple habits.




THE 8 RISKS

**01** Confidential data leaves the office
**02** Wrong answers that look right
**03** Unclear responsibility and liability
**04** Breaking the rules without knowing
**05** Lock-in and rising costs
**06** New security holes
**07** People are left behind
**08** Spending without results

Placement is my assessment for a typical small or medium office in its first year with AI. Your own map will differ: use the checklist on page 08 to draw it.

**The goal is not to avoid AI. It is to use it with your eyes open: know the risk, check the output, and keep people responsible.**

RISK 01

## Confidential data leaves the office

LIKELIHOOD · HIGH | IMPACT · HIGH

> **Example:** an estimator pastes a client's contract, or uploads a model with names and prices, into a free AI chatbot to "summarise it quickly". Depending on the tool's terms, that data may be stored or used to train future models, and it may breach your NDA with the client.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ Staff use personal or free AI accounts for work
- ☐ Nobody knows which tools are in use
- ☐ There is no rule about client data

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ Sort data into green (public), amber (internal) and red (client or personal) and agree what may go where
- ☐ Use business plans whose terms exclude training on your data
- ☐ Remove names and prices before sharing; keep red data in local tools
- ☐ Check client contracts and NDAs for rules on third-party software

RISK 02

## Wrong answers that look right

LIKELIHOOD · HIGH | IMPACT · HIGH

> **Example:** an AI-written script counts the modules in a tender model but silently skips objects on a hidden layer. The quantity looks plausible, goes into the price, and the error only shows up in production.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ Outputs are used without anyone checking them
- ☐ Scripts are copied from a chat and run as they are
- ☐ Nobody can explain how a number was calculated

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ AI drafts, people decide: a named person checks anything that leaves the office
- ☐ Test every tool on a past project where you know the right answer
- ☐ Make tools report what they skip, so nothing disappears silently
- ☐ Spot-check a sample of results every week during the first months

RISK 03

LIKELIHOOD · LOW | IMPACT · HIGH

## Unclear responsibility and liability

> **Example:** a detail or calculation prepared with AI turns out to be wrong after construction. The client asks who is responsible, and the office's professional indemnity insurance was never told that AI tools were part of the process.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ AI output goes straight into signed documents
- ☐ Contracts say nothing about AI or software use
- ☐ Checks are done but not recorded

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ Structural, fire and legal decisions stay with qualified professionals
- ☐ Ask your insurer and lawyer how AI use affects your cover and contracts
- ☐ Record who checked what, and when, for important deliverables

RISK 04

LIKELIHOOD · MEDIUM | IMPACT · MEDIUM

## Breaking the rules without knowing

> **Example:** a team feeds CVs, timesheets or residents' data into an AI tool without a legal basis under GDPR, or uses AI-generated images or text that copy someone else's work.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ Personal data is used in AI tools without checking
- ☐ No one in the company follows the EU AI Act
- ☐ AI is used in hiring or staff evaluation

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ Keep a short list of the AI tools you use and what for
- ☐ Train staff in AI basics: the EU AI Act asks companies to support AI literacy
- ☐ Treat personal data as red data and involve your data protection advisor
- ☐ Check licences of AI-generated code, images and text before using them commercially

RISK 05

## Lock-in and rising costs

LIKELIHOOD · MEDIUM | IMPACT · MEDIUM

> **Example:** the office pays for five AI subscriptions that overlap, a key tool changes its price or model overnight, and the only person who understands the custom scripts leaves the company.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ Subscriptions keep growing and nobody reviews them
- ☐ Tools only work in one supplier's platform
- ☐ There is no documentation of custom tools

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ Own the source code of tools built for you, and keep it in your own storage
- ☐ Write a one-page manual for every tool and name an owner
- ☐ Review AI subscriptions every six months against real use

RISK 06

## New security holes

LIKELIHOOD · MEDIUM | IMPACT · HIGH

> **Example:** a script generated by AI deletes or overwrites files on the shared drive, or an AI assistant with access to email and folders follows hidden instructions inside a document it was asked to read.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ AI tools have access to more folders than they need
- ☐ Code from AI is run without being read
- ☐ IT is not involved in choosing AI tools

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ Give AI tools the minimum access they need
- ☐ Read and test AI-written code on copies before using it on live files
- ☐ Keep backups and let IT approve new tools

RISK 07

## People are left behind

LIKELIHOOD · HIGH | IMPACT · MEDIUM

> **Example:** management buys an AI tool, but the team is not trained, fears for their jobs and keeps working the old way, while a few people quietly use their own AI accounts.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ Tools are bought but hardly used
- ☐ Only one enthusiast knows how things work
- ☐ People hide that they use AI

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ Involve the people who do the work in choosing the first task
- ☐ Train on your own project files, not generic examples
- ☐ Be open about the goal: less repetitive work, not fewer people

RISK 08

## Spending without results

LIKELIHOOD · HIGH | IMPACT · LOW

> **Example:** a company starts with a big AI platform for “everything”, automates a process that was already broken, and after a year cannot say how many hours it saved.

WARNING SIGNS

- ☐ Pilots never reach daily use
- ☐ No one measured the hours before starting
- ☐ The goal is “use AI”, not a specific task

HOW TO REDUCE IT

- ☐ Start with one task that repeats on every project
- ☐ Fix the process first, then automate it
- ☐ Measure hours before and after, and only scale what works

REGULATION SNAPSHOT · OCTOBER 2026

# What the EU rules mean for a construction company

For most offices, everyday uses such as drafting, scripting, quantities and checks are low risk under the EU AI Act. The duties that apply to almost everyone are training your staff and protecting personal data.

| WHEN | WHAT IT MEANS |
|---|---|
| Since Feb 2025 | **AI literacy (AI Act, Art. 4).** Companies that use AI must take measures so their staff understand the AI they use. The July 2026 update kept this duty, in a lighter form. |
| Since Feb 2025 | **Banned uses.** A short list of AI practices is prohibited, such as manipulative techniques and some types of biometric surveillance. Normal office automation is not affected. |
| Since Aug 2026 | **Transparency (Art. 50).** People must be told in some cases when they interact with AI or see AI-generated content, for example a public chatbot on your website. |
| From Dec 2027 | **High-risk AI** (moved from August 2026). Mostly AI in areas such as hiring, staff evaluation or critical infrastructure. Using AI to hire or assess staff is where construction companies are most likely to meet it. |
| From Aug 2028 | **AI inside regulated products**, such as safety components of machinery. |
| Always | **GDPR.** Personal data (names, CVs, residents, photos of people) needs a legal basis and care with where it is processed, AI or not. |
| Always | **Contracts, NDAs and copyright.** Client agreements may limit third-party software; AI-generated code, images and text may carry licence or copyright questions. |

Dates reflect the AI Act as amended by the Digital Omnibus on AI, published in July 2026. This page is general guidance, not legal advice: check the current text and your own situation with a legal or data protection advisor.

BEFORE YOU START

# Ten questions to answer before implementing AI

Every “no” is a risk to deal with first. Most can be solved in a single meeting.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Do we know which AI tools our staff use today, including personal accounts? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 02 | Have we agreed which data may go into which tools (green, amber, red)? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 03 | Do our AI subscriptions exclude training on our data? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 04 | Does a named person check AI output before it leaves the office? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 05 | Have we tested each tool on a project where we know the right answer? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 06 | Have we told our insurer and checked client contracts? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 07 | Have our staff had basic AI training on our own work? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 08 | Do we own the code and documentation of custom tools? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 09 | Do AI tools have only the access they need, with backups in place? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |
| 10 | Did we measure the hours before starting, so we can prove the result? | ☐ Yes ☐ No |

### 0–4 yes

Agree a basic AI policy (next page) before you go further.

### 5–8 yes

Fix the gaps, then start a pilot on one task.

### 9–10 yes

You are ready to scale. Review the answers every six months.

TEMPLATE

# A one-page AI policy for your office

Fill this in together with your team. One page that everyone has read protects you more than a long document nobody opens.

## AI policy of _____

**Approved AI tools**

Which tools, which plan, who pays

**Data rules**

| GREEN | AMBER | RED |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Public or general: standards, product data, your own drafts | Internal: anonymised models and quantities, internal processes | Client or personal: contracts, prices, names, CVs. Only in approved or local tools |

**Checks**

Who checks AI output, and what is always checked by a person

**Never with AI**

For example: signing off structure or fire safety, hiring decisions

**Owner**

The person who keeps this policy and the tool list up to date

**Training**

When new and current staff are trained

**Review date**

Every six months

NEXT STEP

# Want to start with AI, safely?

I'm Lavinia Lorena Jilavu, a BIM expert in Málaga. I helped bring AI into daily work at a modular timber company and built around 30 tools with it, learning these risks first-hand. I can help you:

- ☐ **Map your risks** as part of a workflow audit, with a clear plan to reduce them.
- ☐ **Write your AI policy** together with your team, using the template in this guide.
- ☐ **Train your staff** on your own project files: what AI does well, and what to always check.
- ☐ **Build tools you own**, tested on your projects, with reports that show what they skip.

## Book a free first session

Half a day on one of your real tasks, with no commitment.


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This guide is general information, not legal, insurance or security advice.